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The Predictable Church

How to Know What You'll Receive Next Month (Before It Arrives)

What if you knew exactly how much was coming in next month?

What's inside:

- Why unpredictable income keeps churches in survival mode
- The 3 types of church income (and which one matters most)
- Why pledge drives fail — and what to do instead
- A free 6-step method to build predictable income today
- What automated recurring giving looks like in practice
- A self-assessment calculator for your church

A free planning guide for church leaders by Algolog Limited | autogiving.ng

THE COST OF UNPREDICTABLE INCOME

Every church has ambitions. Hire more staff. Start a building project. Fund missions. Expand the children's ministry. Support community outreach. These are not luxuries — they are the work of the church.

But most churches cannot commit to any of these because they do not know what next month's income will be. When the offering varies by 30–40% from one Sunday to the next, every plan becomes a gamble, and every budget becomes a guess.

The result: churches operate in survival mode — paying bills month to month, never truly investing in growth. Leaders spend their energy managing cash flow instead of fulfilling vision.

Here are the conversations happening in church offices across Nigeria right now:

- "We want to hire a youth pastor, but we are not sure we can sustain the salary."
- "We started the building project, but had to pause because giving dropped for two months."
- "We promised the missionaries monthly support, but some months we can barely cover our own rent."
- "We approved the outreach programme in January, but by March we had to scale it back."

These are not failures of faith or generosity. They are the natural consequence of a structural problem: when 80% or more of your income comes from spontaneous, weekly offerings, every budget is a prayer.

What it looks like in numbers:

A church averaging NGN 4M/month in offerings with 80% coming from unpredictable sources has only NGN 800K it can actually count on. The other NGN 3.2M might come… or it might not.

That is not a budget — it is a hope.

THE 3 TYPES OF CHURCH INCOME

Understanding your income mix is the first step toward financial stability. Not all church income is equal — and the difference matters enormously for planning.

Type 1: Spontaneous Giving

One-time offerings, visitor gifts, special Sunday appeals. This income is completely unpredictable. It depends on attendance, mood, personal circumstances, and whether it rained on Sunday morning.

Important for engagement, but dangerous as a primary income source.

Type 2: Seasonal Giving

Harvest thanksgiving, Christmas, Easter, special project fundraisers. The timing is predictable, but the amounts are not.

This often creates a "feast and famine" cycle — a huge December followed by a dry January and February. Churches that depend heavily on seasonal giving live on a financial rollercoaster.

Type 3: Committed Recurring Giving

The same amount, the same frequency, every week or every month, automatically. Rain or shine. Travel or not. This is the floor — the income you KNOW will arrive regardless of attendance, weather, or holidays.

The healthiest churches worldwide have 50–70% of income from Type 3. Most Nigerian churches have less than 10% from committed recurring giving.

The ideal income mix:

Income Type	Ideal %	What It Provides
Committed Recurring	**50–60%**	Your predictable floor — budget with confidence
Spontaneous	20–30%	Engagement and growth — visitors, special moments
Seasonal	10–20%	Special projects and celebrations

> **"The goal is not to eliminate spontaneous or seasonal giving. It is to build a predictable floor so your church can plan with confidence."**

THE PLEDGE GAP — WHY GOOD INTENTIONS DON'T PAY BILLS

Many churches have tried "pledge drives" or "faith promises" — asking members to commit to a monthly amount. The intention is right. The execution breaks down.

The reality: 40–60% of verbal pledges go unfulfilled.

Why pledges fail:

1. **Life gets busy.**
   The intention was real when the pledge card was filled out. But there is no system to execute it. Monday comes, the week gets hectic, and the pledge is forgotten by Wednesday.

2. **No reminder mechanism.**
   The pledge card sits in a drawer or gets lost. There is nothing prompting the member to act on their commitment when the time comes.

3. **Giving is still manual.**
   Even committed members forget some weeks. Manual giving requires a conscious decision every single time — and that is a lot of decisions over a year.

4. **No accountability loop.**
   The church does not know who is behind until months later when the finance team reconciles. By then, the moment to follow up has passed.

5. **Embarrassment.**
   Members who fall behind on their pledges feel ashamed. Instead of catching up, they disengage further. The pledge that was meant to increase giving actually reduces it.

> "The problem is not the commitment. The problem is the gap between intention and execution. Good systems close that gap."

THE FREE FIX — BUILDING PREDICTABLE INCOME WITHOUT SOFTWARE

You do not need to buy any software to start solving this. Here are six steps you can implement this month:

Your free 6-step method:

1. **Identify your committed core.**
   Look at your giving records for the past 6 months. Find your top 20–30 consistent givers — the people who give every Sunday regardless. They have already proven their faithfulness. They just need a better system.

2. **Have personal conversations.**
   This is NOT a public announcement. It is a personal, one-on-one conversation. Say: "We are trying to build a more predictable foundation for the church. Would you be open to setting up a monthly standing order with your bank for your tithe? It is completely voluntary."

3. **Help them set it up.**
   Most Nigerian banks offer free standing orders. Provide the church account details and walk them through the process. Remove every friction point. If possible, have someone available after service to help.

4. **Track commitments in a simple spreadsheet.**
   Columns: Member Name | Monthly Amount | Bank | Standing Order Set Up? | Jan | Feb | Mar... Track who committed and who has actually started.

5. **Review monthly.**
   Check which standing orders actually came through. Follow up gently with anyone who committed but has not started. A simple WhatsApp message is enough: "Just checking in — is everything okay with the standing order?"

6. **Calculate your predictable floor.**
   Total of all active, confirmed standing orders. This is the amount you can actually budget against with confidence.

The impact: If 25 members commit to an average of NGN 50,000/month, that is NGN 1.25 million in predictable monthly income. That is enough to hire a staff member, fund a mission, or start a building savings plan — with confidence.

An honest note: Standing orders are a good start, but they have real limitations in Nigeria. Banks sometimes miss payments without explanation. Members cannot easily adjust amounts if their circumstances change — they have to visit the bank or call. There is no receipt or category tracking (the church cannot tell tithes from offerings from building fund). And you are still manually following up every month. It works for your first 20–30 committed givers — but it does not scale, and it breaks when banks fail.

THE AUTOMATED FIX — WHAT TRULY PREDICTABLE GIVING LOOKS LIKE

Here is what giving looks like when there is a proper system behind it:

The automated workflow:

1. **Your church gets a branded giving link.**
   autogiving.ng/yourchurch — with your church name, logo, and colours. Share it once from the pulpit, in the WhatsApp group, on your church website.

2. **Members choose a category and set their giving.**
   Tithes, Offerings, Building Fund, Missions — whatever categories your church has set up. They choose an amount and frequency (weekly or monthly).

3. **First payment goes through, card is securely saved.**
   From then on, giving is automatic. Every week or every month. Whether they attend or not. Whether it rains or not. Whether they are in Abuja or Lagos or London.

4. **Your dashboard shows your predictable floor.**
   "42 members have active recurring subscriptions totaling NGN 2.8M/month." That is your predictable floor. Budget against it with confidence.

5. **Members control their own giving.**
   If a member needs to pause (travel, financial hardship), they do it themselves online — no awkward conversation needed. They can resume whenever they are ready.

6. **Automatic receipts and full visibility.**
   Members get email and SMS receipts after every transaction. The church sees total recurring vs one-time giving, giving by category, trends over time. Export to CSV anytime.

7. **Funds go directly to your church bank account.**
   Never touches Algolog or any other account. Paystack subaccount technology ensures direct settlement to your church's own bank account.

This is Pledged — your members set it up once, and giving continues rain or shine, holiday or not.

No forgotten standing orders. No manual tracking. No awkward follow-ups. No bank failures to chase. Just predictable income your church can plan around.

THE PREDICTABLE CHURCH CALCULATOR

Use this worksheet to see where your church stands today — and what changes with recurring giving:

	Current	With 25 Recurring	With 50 Recurring
Avg Monthly Offering	NGN _____	NGN _____	NGN _____
Predictable (Recurring)	NGN _____ (____%)	NGN _____ (____%)	NGN _____ (____%)
Unpredictable	NGN _____ (____%)	NGN _____ (____%)	NGN _____ (____%)
Budget Confidently?	**?**	**Getting there**	**Yes**

SELF-ASSESSMENT: IS YOUR CHURCH INCOME PREDICTABLE?

Answer these five statements honestly. Count how many are true for your church.

#	Statement	Yes / No
1	Our church budget is based on estimates, not committed income	
2	We have had to delay or cancel a project because giving was lower than expected	
3	We do not know what percentage of our income is recurring vs one-time	
4	We have tried pledge drives but most pledges went unfulfilled	
5	We cannot tell members exactly how much they gave last year if they ask	

Your score:

0–1: Your church is in good shape. You likely already have systems supporting predictable income. Automation would save your team time and give members a better experience.

2–3: There are gaps in your giving infrastructure. The free fix on the previous page will make an immediate difference. Automation would transform your financial planning.

4–5: Your church is operating without a predictable income floor. Every budget is a guess. This is the single most impactful thing you can address — and it starts with helping your members give consistently.

FREE 15-MINUTE CHURCH GIVING AUDIT

We only do 10 of these per month, so we can give each church our full attention.

In 15 minutes, we'll look at your current giving patterns, identify the biggest gaps between intention and execution, and show you exactly what a recurring giving system would look like for your church — branded with your name, logo, and colours.

No obligation. No pressure. Just a conversation about what is possible for your church.

Book your free audit:

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This guide was prepared by Algolog Limited, a Nigerian technology company that builds tools to help churches and organisations operate more effectively. Our platform, Pledged (autogiving.ng), enables churches to set up branded recurring giving in minutes — no app download needed, funds go directly to the church's bank account.

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